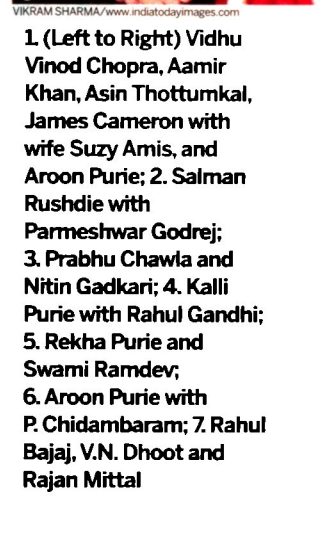
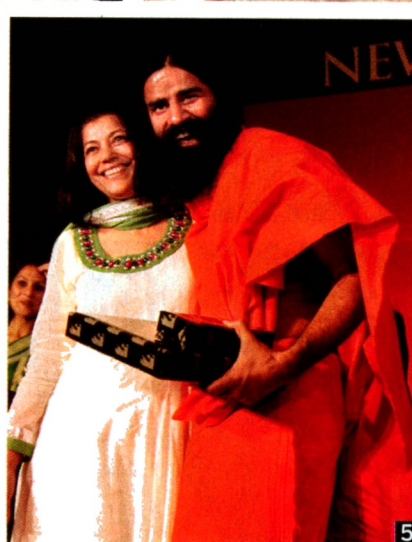




1 (Left to Right) Vidhu Vinod Chopra, Aamir Khan, Asin Thottumkal, James Cameron with wife Suzy Amis, and Aroon Purie; 2. Salman Rushdie with Parmeshwar Godrej; 3. Prabhu Chawla and Nitin Gadkari; 4. Kalli Purie with Rahul Gandhi; 5. Rekha Purie and Swami Ramdev; 6. Aroon Purie with P. Chidambaram; 7. Rahul Bajaj, V.N. Dhoot and Rajan Mittal

more charisma than the Hollywood fellow.”

Charisma was in abundance, from the speaker lineup to those in the audience, including Rahul Gandhi who was eager to hear David Bloom speak on India’s “demographic dividend”. Rahul took notes, presumably to use in his avatar as the man tasked with reviving the Youth Congress. Characteristically, when offered a chair in the front, he politely opted for the second row and made a quiet exit to avoid a fuss. Elsewhere, Parmeshwar Godrej bonded with Facebook founder Chris Hughes and daughter Tanya Dubash who had spoken forcefully at the youth session earlier that day. Actor Asin, who spoke at the same session,

shimmered in a beige sequinned dress while she chatted with Khan and Cameron at dinner. Rahul Bajaj opted to keep a low profile till the evening started to become a swirl of glitter and colour. Talking of colour, red seemed to be the colour of the evening with Rekha Purie in a striking red dupatta and daughter Kalli also opting for red along with Godrej who spent most of the time with old friend Rushdie.

It wasn’t party time for everyone. The Religare-Fortis brothers Malvinder Singh and Shivinder Singh were held up by “company business”. Just a day before the conclave, they had acquired a majority holding in Asia’s largest health care provider, the Singapore-based Parkway, making them